

TOPIC 4: BASIC COMPUTER HARDWARE COMPONENTS I

1. Meaning of Hardware

Hardware refers to the physical parts of a computer system that you can see and touch. Examples: keyboard, monitor, mouse, system unit, printer.

2. Input Devices

Devices used to enter data into the computer:

- Keyboard – typing text and commands
- Mouse – pointing and selecting
- Scanner – converting paper documents into digital form
- Microphone – inputting sound
- Webcam – capturing images and video
- Touchscreen – input by touch
- Joystick / Game controller

3. Output Devices

Devices that display or produce results from the computer:

- Monitor / Screen – displays text, images and video
- Printer – produces hard copies (inkjet, laser)
- Speakers – output sound
- Projector – displays output on a large screen
- Headphones / Earphones

4. Functions and Identification

Students should be able to identify each device and state its main function (input or output). The system unit (CPU case) houses the motherboard, processor, memory and storage drives.

5. Simple Maintenance Practices

- Keep devices clean (dust keyboard, wipe screen gently)
- Avoid eating or drinking near the computer
- Use a surge protector / stabilizer
- Shut down properly; do not force power off
- Handle cables carefully; do not bend them sharply
- Keep liquids away from hardware

6. Summary

Hardware is the physical part of a computer. Input devices enter data; output devices display results. Proper care and maintenance extend the life of devices.

End of Topic 4